

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 5 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ A 7 3

♣ J 6 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ J 6

♣ A K Q 10 4



♠ K 9 6 3

♥ Q J 10 7

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 8 3

♠ J 8

♥ 9 6 2

♦ K Q 10 9 4

♣ 9 7 5

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥Q

three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that North started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

This defense holds North to one ♦ tricks, if you had let him win the second one he would have had 9 tricks.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥Q, you played low and North won the ♥A.

North now plays the ♦J on which East plays the ♦2. What do you play now, and what is your plan.

Play the ♦3 and when North plays another ♦ win with your ♦A.

South hoped his ♦ suit would provide enough tricks to make the game. You can see that there is no entry to the South hand EXCEPT in ♦s, so you want to win your ♦A on the trick that North plays his last ♦. How can you tell which trick that is?

Only by watching what East plays. On the ♦J East played the ♦2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or

three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that North started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 8 7

♦ Q 6 5

♣ 9 7 6 4

♠ 8 7 2

♥ J 9 5 2

♦ A 8 4 3

♣ 8 3



♠ J 10 4

♥ A K 3

♦ J 10 9

♣ A K Q J

♠ A 6 5

♥ Q 10 6 4

♦ K 7 2

♣ 10 5 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

1 ♣

Pass

3NT

2NT

Pass

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♥4

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, North plays the ♥J, won by East with ♥A.

East plays the ♠J, you follow with ♠5, dummy ♠3 and North plays the ♠2. East continues with the ♠10

Play the ♠6.

North's ♠2 tells you he had an ODD number of ♠s, obviously 3. Since East also must have 3, you must take your ♠A on the third round, depriving dummy of the extra ♠ trick.

East may now turn to the ♦ suit, but your side can win the first ♦ and drive out East's ♥K. You will win 2 ♥s, 2 ♦s and the ♠A, down 1

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4  
 ♥ A 8 7 5 2  
 ♦ 7 5 2  
 ♣ 6 4 2

♠ K J 6  
 ♥ J 10 6 3  
 ♦ A Q 6  
 ♣ Q 10 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 9 7 3 2  
 ♥ —  
 ♦ 10 9 8 4 3  
 ♣ A K J 9

♠ A Q 10 5  
 ♥ K Q 9 4  
 ♦ K J  
 ♣ 8 7 3

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| Pass         | 3NT   |      | 1NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥5     |       |      |       |

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥10

Play the ♦3 (or the ♠2).

You really want West to lead a ♣ if he gets into the lead. If you discard the ♣9 West will surely get the message and will lead a ♣. BUT - you will only win 3 ♣ tricks. The ♣9 would have been the fourth winner.

So instead, play a low card in one of the other suits, say the ♦3.

South is one trick short and he sees he can easily get that trick in ♥s. So he plays a second ♥ from dummy and you now discard the ♠2. West takes the ♥A and he can see that you don't want him to lead a ♠ or a ♦. He deduces that you might like a ♣ so he plays his ♣2 and you win 4 tricks.

**Board 4**

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 10 9 4 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ A K

♣ Q 8

♠ 6 5 3

♥ 4

♦ J 8 6 4 2

♣ J 9 4 3



♠ K J 7

♥ Q J 2

♦ Q 10 3

♣ K 10 7 5

♠ 8

♥ A 10 9 7 6 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6 2

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥ 4

You are North. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥ 4, South takes the ♥ A and returns the ♥ 3. You ruff and then play what???

Play a low ♣.

Partner played the ♥ 3, a low card, for you to ruff. That means his re-entry, if he has one, is in the lower-ranking suit.

Partner takes the ♣ A and gives you a second ♥ ruff.

**Board 5**

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 4  
 ♥ 9 5 3  
 ♦ Q 7 2  
 ♣ A Q J 4

♠ A

♥ A K J 8 7 2

♦ J 10 5

♣ 10 5 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ J 8 6 3

♥ 10 6

♦ A K 8 4

♣ 8 7 2

♠ K Q 7 5 2

♥ Q 4

♦ 9 6 3

♣ K 9 6

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 1 ♥   | Pass | 1 ♠   |
| Pass         | 2 ♥   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 2 ♥ by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦ A    |       |      |       |

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♦ A, dummy played the ♦ 3

Play the ♦ 2.

You know partner also has the ♦ K, and normally you would give an encouraging signal when you hold the Queen. But with this hand you want partner to switch to ♣s as soon as possible. So you play a low ♦.

East looks at your signal, then looks at dummy, then looks at your signal. He knows you want a switch and it looks like a switch to ♣s might work the best. North plays a low ♣ from dummy, you win the ♣J. Next you play a low ♦, taken by East with his ♦K. East leads a ♣. Dummy plays the ♣K, you win that, cash another ♣, then cash your ♦Q. That first signal led to your side winning the first 6 tricks. Wow.

**Board 6**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 10 3

♥ 10 6

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K Q J 3 2

♠ 8

♥ Q J 8 4 3

♦ Q J 10 4

♣ 8 7 6



♠ K Q J 7 5 2

♥ 9 5

♦ K 5

♣ A 10 4

♠ 9 6 4

♥ A K 7 2

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 9 5

*West**North**East**South*

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♥ A

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥ A, North puts on the ♥ Q. It's your play.

Play the ♥ 2.

North's ♥ Q is either a singleton, (practically impossible), or a signal showing that he also holds the ♥ J. In either case you can reach the North hand on the second trick by playing a low ♥. Since you don't particularly want to start playing ♦s from your side, you go ahead and play a small ♥, won by North with the ♥ J.

North next plays the ♦ Q and however East tries it your side will take the next two ♦ tricks and set the contract.